

WORKING TITLE

by

Alvaro Belmonte

**A dissertation submitted to Johns Hopkins University
in conformity with the requirements for the degree of
Doctor of Philosophy**

Baltimore, Maryland

June, 2020

© 2026 by Alvaro Belmonte

All rights reserved

Abstract

My thesis is about bla bla

Thesis Committee

Primary Readers

First Lastname (Primary Advisor)
Assistant Professor
Department of ChangeMe
Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health

First Lastname
Assistant Professor
Department of ChangeMe
Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health

First Lastname
Assistant Professor
Department of ChangeMe
Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health

First Lastname
Associate Professor
Affiliation1, and
Department1 & Department2 at
Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health

Alternate Readers

First Lastname

Professor

Department of ChangeMe

Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health

First Lastname

Assistant Professor

Department of ChangeMe

Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health

Acknowledgments

Thanks!

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	vi
List of Tables	vii
List of Figures	viii
1 Outline	1
2 Background	3
2.1 Multicategories	3
2.1.1 The Tensor Product of Multicategories	6
2.1.2 Trees	7
2.1.3 Category of trees Ω	12
2.1.4 Faces and Degeneracies in Ω	13
2.1.4.1 Outer Faces	13
2.1.4.2 Inner Faces	14
References	15

List of Tables

List of Figures

Chapter 1

Outline

1. Background/Preliminaries

(a) (Maybe) Virtual double categories

(b) Multicategories/operads

i. Definition and examples

ii. Operads difference

(c) ∞ -cosmos

i. Definition and example using simplicial sets

ii.

(d) Dendroidal Sets

2. Main Contents

(a) (Maybe) some of the work on lax monoidal structures, but using the virtual double categorical setting.

(b) Showing the model of infinity operads follows most of the axioms of an ∞ -cosmos.

- (c) Introduce the definition of weak ∞ –cosmos and show similar results from preliminaries still follows

Chapter 2

Background

2.1 Multicategories

EXPLAIN THE SOURCE OF THIS MATERIAL. “Multicategories were first defined in ...” “Our exposition follows ...” yes Multicategories are a generalization of categories. In categories, arrows have a single source/domain and a single target/codomain. In multicategories, the arrows have a finite sequence of sources/inputs and a single target/output.

Definition 2.1.1. A *multicategory* $\mathcal{M}$ consist of a set S of objects and for each $n \geq 0$ and each sequence $s_1, \dots, s_n, t$ of objects a set

$$\mathcal{M}(s_1, \dots, s_n; t)$$

of multiarrows/operations, thought of as taking n inputs objects $s_1, \dots, s_n$ respectively to the output object t . Moreover, there are three kinds of structure maps:

- For each object s , an identity/unit $1_s \in \mathcal{M}(s; s)$

- For any sequence of objects $s_1, \dots, s_n, t$ and any n -tuple of sequences $d_1^i, \dots, d_{k_i}^i$ of objects for $i = 1, \dots, n$, a composition function of multiarrows/operations

$$\gamma : \mathcal{M}(s_1, \dots, s_n; t) \times \prod_{i=1}^n \mathcal{M}(d_1^i, \dots, d_{k_i}^i; s_i) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}(d_1^1, \dots, d_{k_1}^1, d_1^2, \dots, d_{k_n}^n; t),$$

usually written $p \circ (q_1, \dots, q_n) := \gamma(p, q_1, \dots, q_n)$ or even just $p(q_1, \dots, q_n)$

Furthermore these structure maps have to satisfy a number of axioms, which express that composition is unital and associative (Heuts and Moerdijk, 2022)

Remark 2.1.2. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a multicategory, $f \in \mathcal{M}(s_1, \dots, s_n; t)$ and $g \in \mathcal{M}(d_1, \dots, d_l; s_i)$ for some $1 \leq i \leq n$. It will be convenient to have the following notation:

$$f \circ_i g := f(1_{s_1}, \dots, g, \dots, 1_{s_n})$$

Thus, $f \circ_i g$ is the composition of f with g in the i th variable.

Example 2.1.3. You can think of n -ary multiarrows in $\mathcal{M}(s_1, \dots, s_n; t)$ as n -ary operations. Let M be the multicategory with a single object X . Then the n -ary multiarrows in $M(X, \dots, X; X)$ define to be the set of functions

$$f : X \times \dots \times X \rightarrow X$$

where the domain is the n -fold cartesian product of X with itself.

Example 2.1.4. We can up the level from the previous example, by fixing a family of sets $\{X_c\}_{c \in C}$ indexed by a set of objects C . Then you can think of the multiarrows in $\mathcal{M}(c_1, \dots, c_n; c)$ as n -ary operations, taking inputs of types $c_1, \dots, c_n$ respectively to an output of type c .

For example, for a fixed family of sets $\{X_c\}_{c \in C}$, define a multicategory $\mathcal{M}$ whose objects is the set of colors C , and whose multiarrows are defined by declaring $\mathcal{M}(c_1, \dots, c_n; c)$ to be the set of functions

$$p : X_{c_1} \times \dots \times X_{c_n} \rightarrow X_c$$

Composition in $\mathcal{M}$ is defined as composition of functions.

Example 2.1.5. The previous two examples are specific instances of a more general family of examples. If $\mathcal{C}$ is a symmetric monoidal category and C is a set of objects of $\mathcal{C}$, then one obtains a multicategory with this set of objects by defining $\mathcal{M}(c_1, \dots, c_m; t)$ to be the set of morphisms $c_1 \otimes \dots \otimes c_m \rightarrow t$ in $\mathcal{C}$. We will sometimes write $\mathcal{C}^\otimes$ for the multicategory obtained in this way, when C is the set of all objects of $\mathcal{C}$ (granted it is small).

Example 2.1.6. A (small) category $\mathcal{C}$ can be considered as a multicategory $\mathcal{C}_m$ which only have unary arrows. I.e. the set $\mathcal{C}_m(c_1, \dots, c_n; c)$ is always empty unless $n = 1$.

We can observe that multicategories form a category $\mathcal{MCat}$.

Definition 2.1.7. For two multicategories $\mathcal{M}$ and $\mathcal{N}$, a *multifunctor* $\phi : \mathcal{M} \rightarrow \mathcal{N}$ consist of:

- A function $f : O_{\mathcal{M}} \rightarrow O_{\mathcal{N}}$ between the corresponding sets of objects
- For each sequence $s_1, \dots, s_n, t$ of objects of $\mathcal{M}$, a map

$$\phi_{s_1, \dots, s_n, t} : \mathcal{M}(s_1, \dots, s_n; t) \rightarrow \mathcal{N}(f(s_1), \dots, f(s_n); f(t)).$$

So that these maps are compatible with compositions and units in the obvious way.

2.1.1 The Tensor Product of Multicategories

Let M and N be multicategories. Their Boardman-Vogt tensor product $M \otimes_{BV} N$ is a multicategory defined to make sense of what a M -algebra in the category of N -algebras is and viceversa. We will not talk about the algebras of a multicategories here, but we refer the reader to [look for reference]

Definition 2.1.8. The *Boardman-Vogt tensor* $M \otimes_{BV} N$ in terms of generators and relations. The set of objects of this multicategory is the product of the sets of objects of M and N ; if x and y are objects of M and N respectively, we write $x \otimes y$ for the corresponding object of $M \otimes_{BV} N$. The generating multiarrows of $M \otimes_{BV} N$ are of two types:

- For each multiarrow $f \in M(x_1, \dots, x_n, x)$ and object y of N , a multiarrow

$$f \otimes y \in (M \otimes_{BV} N)(x_1 \otimes y, \dots, x_n \otimes y; x \otimes y)$$

- For each object x of M and multiarrow $g \in N(y_1, \dots, y_m; y)$, a multiarrow

$$x \otimes g \in (M \otimes_{BV} N)(x \otimes y_1, \dots, x \otimes y_m; x \otimes y)$$

The relations to be satisfied by these generators are the following:

$$(1) (f \otimes y)(f_1 \otimes y, \dots, f_n \otimes y) = f(f_1, \dots, f_n) \otimes y$$

$$(2) (x \otimes g)(x \otimes g_1, \dots, x \otimes g_m) = x \otimes g(g_1, \dots, g_m)$$

$$(3) \sigma^*(f \otimes y) = (\sigma^* f) \otimes y \text{ for } \sigma \in \Sigma_n$$

$$(4) \sigma^*(x \otimes g) = x \otimes (\sigma^* g) \text{ for } \sigma \in \Sigma_m$$

$$(5) (f \otimes y)(x_1 \otimes g, \dots, x_n \otimes g) = \sigma_{n,m}^*((x \otimes g)(f \otimes y_1, \dots, f \otimes y_m))$$

Note that relations (1) and (2) say precisely the condition that for any object y of N there is a multifunction $- \otimes y : M \rightarrow M \otimes_{BV} N$. Similarly, for any object x of M there is a multifunction $x \otimes - : N \rightarrow M \otimes_{BV} N$, this time given by relations (2) and (4). Relation (5) is the most interesting; most often referred to it as the *Boardman-Vogt interchange relation*. The permutation $\sigma_{n,m} \in \Sigma_{nm}$ is the one that makes sense of formula (5), i.e. the element relating the sequences $(x_1 \otimes y_1, \dots, x_1 \otimes y_m, \dots, x_n \otimes y_1, \dots, x_n \otimes y_m)$ and $(x_1 \otimes d_1, \dots, x_n \otimes d_1, \dots, x_1 \otimes d_m, \dots, x_n \otimes d_m)$.

2.1.2 Trees

We will do a quick detour to talk about our main combinatorial object that is gonna help us with studying multicategories, trees. We are mainly interested in finite rooted trees. So we don't get confused with the more general notion of tree in graph theory, we will give a precise definition of what we mean by a tree in this thesis. We will see that these trees give rise to free multicategories whose objects are the edges of the tree and morphisms are generated by the vertices of the tree.

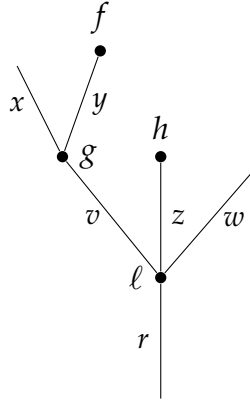
Definition 2.1.9. A *tree* T consist of a finite set V of *vertices*, a nonempty finite set E of *edges*, a distinguished element $r \in E$ called the *root*, together with the following data:

- (1) a function $I : E - \{r\} \rightarrow V$, which we think of as assigning to an edge e the vertex $I(e)$ of which is an input. The way to think about this function is that " $I(e) = f$ if and only if e is an input edge of f "
- (2) A function $O : V \rightarrow E$, assigning to each vertex g its output edge $O(g)$. The way to think about this function is that " $O(f) = x$ if and only if x is the output edge of f "

For each edge e other than the root r , we obtain a sequence of edges starting at e by repeatedly applying $O \circ I$. We demand that this sequence ends in the root r after finitely many steps, for an arbitrary starting edge.

As we can see the main difference between our definition of a tree and the usual definition of a tree in graph theory is that we allow for "orphan"/"leaf" edges that are not attached to any vertex as an output edge, and a unique designed edge that will not be attached to any vertex as an input edge (the root). This special edge also gives us a natural orientation of the tree, where we think of the root as the bottom and the leaves as the top, and thus a partial ordering on both the set of edges and the set of vertices.

Example 2.1.10. A typical tree T with $E(T) = \{x, y, z, w, v, r\}$ and $V(T) = \{f, g, h, l\}$ could look like:



We can fully define both functions for this small example as:

$$I(x) = I(y) = g, \quad I(v) = I(z) = I(w) = \ell$$

$$O(f) = y, \quad O(g) = v, \quad O(h) = z, \quad O(\ell) = r$$

Now I will introduce some terminology to talk about the different parts of a tree. The edges in the complement of the image of O are called *leaves* of the tree T . The vertices in the complement of the image of I are called *stumps*, or *nullary vertices*. An *outer edge* is an edge that is either the root or a leaf. An *inner edge* is any other edge of T . Such an edge is both an output edge and an input edge for some other vertex. The vertices come in two kinds, *external vertices* which only have one inner edge attached to them, and *internal vertices*. When writing T for a tree, we will usually write $E(T)$ and $V(T)$ for its sets of edges and vertices, respectively.

Example 2.1.11. The smallest possible tree consists of a single edge and no

vertices; this tree will be denoted by μ



Example 2.1.12. The next smallest tree consist of a single edge and single vertex, pictured as:



The valence of a vertex v is the number of input edges it has, i.e. the cardinality of the set $I^{-1}(v)$. A vertex of valence 0 is what we previously called a stump. We previously mention that the sets $E(T)$ and $V(T)$ both have a natural partial ordering. Expounding it, it means that $x < y$ for edges x and y (or $f < g$ for vertices f and g) if there is a sequence of edges starting at x (resp. f) and ending at the root of T , r , and passes through y (resp. g). We will call two edges x and y *incomparable* if they are not related in this partial order.

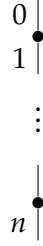
We note that removing an external vertex and all the outer edges attached to it yields a new tree. We will refer to this procedura as *pruning*.

Definition 2.1.13. A tree is called *open* if it has no nullary vertices; on the other side, a tree is called *closed* if it has no leaves.

Definition 2.1.14. A tree is called *linear* if all its vertices have valence one.

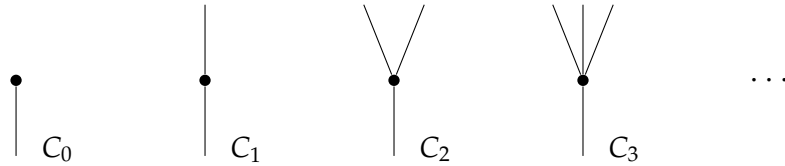
As an example, the tree μ is open but not closed, and generally a tree cannot be both open and closed. A linear tree with $n + 1$ edges running from

the leaf 0 to the root n will be denoted by $[n]$:



The reason for this notation is that the linear trees will become clear in the following section. Note that by our convention the tree obtained from $[n]$ by putting a stump on top will not be referred to as a linear tree.

Another family of trees that we will become familiar with are the *corollas*, which are trees with a single vertex. The corolla with n leaves labeled $1, \dots, n$ and root 0 will be denoted by C_n :



Definition 2.1.15. An *embedding* $\psi : S \rightarrow T$ of trees consists of injective maps $\psi_V : V(S) \rightarrow V(T)$ and $\psi_E : E(S) \rightarrow E(T)$ such that for any vertex f of S , the map ψ_E gives a bijection between $\text{in}(f)$ and $\text{in}(\psi_V(f))$, and $\psi_E(O(f)) = O(\psi_V(f))$. If the an embedding is bijective on both edges and vertices, then it is an isomorphism of trees.

If an embedding of trees, $\iota : S \rightarrow T$ is given by inclusion maps of $E(S) \subseteq E(T)$ and $V(S) \subseteq V(T)$, we will say that S is a *subtree* of T . Then we can see that any embedding $\psi : S \rightarrow T$ factors as an isomorphism followed by the inclusion of a subtree.

A tree T defines a multicategory $\Omega(T)$ as follows:

- The objects of $\Omega(T)$ are the edges of T .
- $\Omega(T)(e_1, \dots, e_n; e)$ is either empty or a singleton if there exist a subtree C_n with leaves $e_1, \dots, e_n$ and root e .
- Composition is given by the tree structure in the obvious way. Expanding the details of it, we get the composition operation/multimap by identifying the root of the precomposing operation with a leaf of the postcomposing operation and squashing this new inner edge and identifying the two vertices to the composition of the two corresponding operations/multimaps.

2.1.3 Category of trees Ω

Dendroidal sets are a generalization of simplicial sets that are particularly well suited to study operads/multicategories and multicategories. Just as simplicial sets are presheaves on the simplex category Δ , dendroidal sets are presheaves on the dendroidal category Ω .

Definition 2.1.16. The category Ω consist of:

1. Objects: finite rooted trees
2. Morphisms: for two trees S and T , a morphism from S to T is a multifunctor $\Omega(S) \rightarrow \Omega(T)$ between the corresponding multicategories.

Another way to say this is that Ω is the full subcategory of $\mathcal{MCat}$ spanned by the multicategories of the form $\Omega(T)$ for some tree T .

The linear trees $[n]$ define a full subcategory of Ω isomorphic to the simplex category Δ . Thus, there is an inclusion functor $i : \Delta \rightarrow \Omega$. This inclusion is compatible with the inclusion of $\mathbf{Cat}$ into $\mathcal{MCat}$ in the sense that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Delta & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{Cat} \\ i \downarrow & & \downarrow j \\ \Omega & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{MCat} \end{array}$$

2.1.4 Faces and Degeneracies in Ω

As we know, the simplex category Δ has two important families of morphisms, the face maps and the degeneracy maps. These maps generate all other morphisms in Δ . Good news for Ω being some multicategorical extension of Δ is that it also has two families of morphisms that generate all other morphisms in Ω .

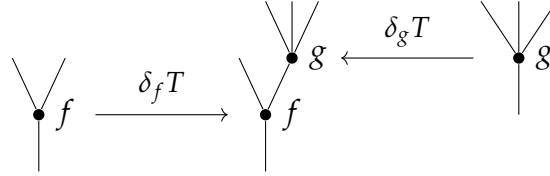
2.1.4.1 Outer Faces

For a tree T and an external vertex f of T , write $\partial_f T$ for the tree obtained by pruning away f and all the outer edges attached to it. This vertex f can be any leaf vertex or it can be the vertex attached to the root of T . This vertex could be any leaf vertex or it can be the vertex attached to the root of T , provided it is only attached to one inner vertex of T . We write

$$\partial_f T \xrightarrow{\delta_f} T$$

for the inclusion of this tree and refer to it as an *outer face*. If f is a leaf vertex we will sometimes specifically speak of a *leaf face*, and similarly for a *root face*.

Example 2.1.17. A leaf face $\partial_g T$ given by the vertex g and a root face $\partial_f T$ given by the vertex f of the following tree T :



There is one case which deserves special mention. For most trees T the notions of leaf vertex and root vertex are distinct. However, for corollas this is not the case. There are $n + 1$ different maps $\mu \rightarrow C_n$ corresponding to the inclusion of each of the n leaves and the root. All of these are by definition outer faces as well.

2.1.4.2 Inner Faces

For a tree T and an inner edge x , let $\partial_x T$ denote the face of T obtained by contracting the edge x , and identifying the vertices f and g at either end of x . This is an *inner face* of T . This gives an inclusion of trees denoted

$$\partial_x T \xrightarrow{\delta_x} T$$

which sends the new vertex obtained by contraction to the subtree of T obtained by grafting the two corollas with vertices f and g along the edge x .

Bibliography

Heuts, Gijs and Ieke Moerdijk (2022). *Simplicial and Dendroidal Homotopy Theory*. Springer Cham.